

Building trust

Feelings of trust are built and nurtured over time. A parent who feels they can trust their teen will be confident about allowing them more independence and privacy.

The advantages of being trustworthy

Trustworthiness is a great attribute to have in life. Looking to the future, a person who is reliable and honest is attractive to employers and more likely to be offered new and exciting opportunities. Friends are also more likely to support someone that they feel they can count on.

At home, too, trust is a great attribute for family members to feel for each other. With the basis of trust established and with parents confident in their child's ability to show good judgment, a teen may gain more freedom.

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△ Healthy relationships

Trust is a big factor in building positive, secure relationships that can endure challenging times.

Trust

Trust is given by one person to another because of what they do. By showing that they are able to behave sensibly, take care of themselves, follow the rules, and contribute to shared family tasks, teens can build their parents' trust in them. Similarly, parents earn trust by supporting their teen.

Honest conversations about problems or misunderstandings are also important for positive family relationships. Bad choices can cause trust to be lost. Everyone makes mistakes, but how a person deals with it is what matters. A genuine apology is the best way to start repairing a relationship after a betrayal of trust.

▽ When things go wrong

Admitting mistakes and not making excuses demonstrates an ability to take responsibility.



TEEN HINTS

Taking responsibility

- Your parents want to keep you safe. Reassure them with honesty—explain who you are with and where you are going, give them a way to stay in contact, and let them know if your plans change.
- Be reliable and keep your promises. Little things are important, such as being on time.
- Following family rules demonstrates responsibility. If you want to change how chores are organized, discuss this with your parents to develop a new routine.
- If family time is requested, such as at mealtimes, make sure you are there, so that when you want to be separate, this will be respected, too.



△ Extra effort

Showing you can help with household tasks will build your parents' trust in you.